

SUM(number1,number2,...)

This is by far the most popular and most widely used of all functions in Excel. Select the last cell in a list of numbers and click on the AutoSum button (Formulas tab, Function Library group) to automatically total up the column or row. You can also manually specify a range, a named range, a range in another worksheet or even one in another workbook.

Example: =SUM(B1:B34,Sheet4!A12:C34)

This will total up the cells B1 to B34 in the current worksheet and the cells A12 to C34 in Sheet4. Note that there is a maximum of 30 arguments separated by commas that you can use in a SUM function. If the number of arguments exceed 30 then you may need to break up the SUM function into two parts.

SUMIF(range,criteria,[sum_range])

For those of you plain bored out by SUM and looking for something more powerful, check out the SUMIF function. The SUMIF function or conditional summing, as its often called, allows you to total up a list based on specific criteria. The range argument specifies the range of cells that you want Excel to evaluate in the sum operation. The criteria argument, as the name implies, is the specific set of criteria that you want to apply to the sum operation, and the sum_range argument is optional, but indicates the range of cells that should be used in the sum function. If the sum_range argument is not specified, Excel will sum the entire range specified in the range argument after applying the criteria argument. This can be better understood by an example.

	A	B	C	D	E
1	Book Title	Category	Price	Totals	Values
2	The Terminal Man	Thriller/Mystery	100	Total for Comics	=SUM(D2:D55,"Comics")
3	The Signs of Tomorrow	Thriller/Mystery	120	Total for Thriller/Mystery	=SUM(D2:D55,"Thriller/Mystery")
4	The Chameleon & the Art	Children's	140	Total for Romance	=SUM(D2:D55,"Romance")
5	The Captain That Lost Ocean 100	Children's	90		
6	The Hurricane	Thriller/Mystery	80		
7	Let's Survive	Comics	100		
8	Don't Walk the Wind	Thriller/Mystery	80		
9	Managing from Safety	Sports	200		
10	Breaking Through	Business	40		
11	Home Sweet Home	Thriller/Mystery	100		
12	The Red Riding Hood	Children's	400		
13	...	...	...		

Using "SUMIF" to get totals